Curriculum of the non-formal education program "Videoactivism Academy"

Implemented by: Organisation "Danes je nov dan"in partnership with the Association "Delta"

DESCRIPTION OF THE EDUCATIONAL PROGRAMME

The "Videoactivism Academy" programme is designed to provide young people aged 18 to 30 with the opportunity to acquire knowledge and develop skills and competences for active, responsible and creative participation in digital spaces. The programme focuses on the development of digital active citizenship, media literacy and young people's ability to create positive digital counter-narratives against hate speech, social polarisation, the spread of disinformation and exclusionary social narratives.

The programme enables young people to become familiar with European values, different forms of civic participation, methods of social, critical and activist online communication, and practical tools for creating digital content. Special emphasis is placed on the development of content for social media, particularly vertical video, and on shaping messages that promote democracy, the rule of law, inclusion, diversity, solidarity and sustainability.

The programme methodology includes methods of non-formal education, experiential learning, project work, collaborative learning and mentoring. Participants are encouraged to actively participate, be creative, think critically, express their own voice and connect with peers, mentors, civil society organisations and young social influencers.

The programme takes place in two main phases, each with specific tasks, duration and learning outcomes.

In the first phase, young people participate in a four-day programme called the "Videoactivism Academy Boot Camp", which brings together 20 participants from Croatia and Slovenia. During the boot camp, participants gain basic knowledge about active citizenship, European values, digital narratives, hate speech, fact-checking, prebunking, message design, and video and sound production. Through workshops, lectures, discussions, analysis of examples and practical work, young people develop their first ideas for digital counter-narratives.

In the second phase, participants continue their involvement through a six-month online mentoring programme. Mentoring takes place through online meetings approximately once a month, additional communication via the online platform Discord, guest lectures, exchange of good practices and continuous work on participants' own digital content. During the mentoring process, participants create videos and other digital formats, share them in the online community to receive feedback, improve them and then publish on social media or share through other online communities or channels.

OBJECTIVES OF THE EDUCATIONAL PROGRAMME

- To encourage and empower young people to act actively and responsibly in the digital space;
- To develop young people's civic, social, digital and media competences while enabling them to connect with peers, mentors, social influencers and civil society organisations from different political and social contexts.
- To introduce young people to European values, especially democracy, the rule of law, human rights, inclusion, diversity, solidarity and sustainability;
- To equip young people to recognise and critically respond to hate speech, polarisation, extremist narratives and disinformation online by using fact-checking, prebunking and responsible communication skills
- To develop practical skills in filming, video editing and sound editing for social media content;
- To encourage young people's creative expression, public advocacy and further civic engagement;

TARGET GROUP

The programme is intended for young people aged 18 to 30 from Croatia and Slovenia who are already active or wish to become creators of socially critical, civic and activist digital content.

A total of 20 participants will be included in this implementation of the programme, 10 from Croatia and 10 from Slovenia. More broadly, the programme is designed for a multicultural learning environment, encouraging participants to learn from peers from different political, social and cultural contexts. At the same time, it is flexible and can be adapted to different target groups, including smaller groups of participants from a single country.

Participants may include young people involved in the work of civil society organisations, civic initiatives, informal groups, student or youth activist groups, as well as young people who have no previous experience in active citizenship but wish to develop their own engagement in the field of digital communication and social change.

Participants are selected through a public call shared via the partners' digital platforms and other relevant communication channels. The programme aims to include young people from rural areas, young people with different educational profiles and age groups within the 18 to 30 age range, young people of different gender identities and sexual orientations, LGBTQIA+ young people, members of minorities and young people with fewer opportunities.

The secondary target group consists of mentors, trainers and expert associates from partner organisations who participate in the implementation of the boot camp and mentoring.

At the same time, the selection and implementation process can be adapted to different contexts and target groups. For example, the programme, or selected parts of it, can also be implemented with more homogeneous groups, such as school classes or existing youth groups, with the content and methodology adjusted to their specific needs and learning environment.

LEARNING OUTCOMES, CONTENT, TEACHING AND LEARNING METHODS, AND EVALUATION METHODS

Learning outcomes	**Content**	**Teaching and learning methods**	**Evaluation methods**
Explain the concept of digital active citizenship	Active citizenship; digital citizenship; online and offline participation; the role of young people and civil society in a democratic society	Workshop; guided discovery; discussion; work on examples; group work	Oral reflection; self-evaluation;
Explain fundamental European values	Democracy; rule of law; human rights; inclusion; diversity; solidarity; sustainability	Interactive lecture; group work; case analysis; discussion	Quiz; group presentation; self-assessment of understanding
Recognise hate speech, polarisation and negative digital narratives	Hate speech; polarisation; extremist and populist narratives; online radicalisation; dynamics of social networks	Analysis of social media examples; guided discussion; group work; narrative mapping	Case analysis; group presentation; mentor comments
Distinguish between narratives, counter-narratives and positive	Digital narratives; counter-narratives; positive narratives;	Workshop; analysis of good practices; work on examples; group work	Developed example of a counter-narrative; group feedback

alternative narratives	socially responsible communication		
Explain and apply the principle of prebunking	Manipulative patterns; preventive exposure of disinformation; prebunking messages	Work on examples; guided discovery; practical task; discussion	Developed prebunking message; mentor feedback
Develop and shape a clear, inclusive and audience-adapted digital counter-narrative.	Target audience; key message; tone of communication; storytelling; humour; emotions; argumentation; call to action; topic selection; problem definition; content objective; format; script; publishing plan	Brainstorming; workshop; pair work; campaign analysis; peer-to-peer feedback; mentored work; individual and group work	Message outline; developed content concept; presentation of idea; comments from group and mentor; mentor feedback
Record and edit basic video or audiovisual content	Vertical video; framing; lighting; sound; basic editing; subtitles; video rhythm; adaptation to platforms	Practical workshop; demonstration; work with equipment; individual and group work	Produced trial digital content; technical and content feedback
Assess one's own development and acquired competences	Self-assessment; Youthpass process; personal plan for further engagement; reflection on learning	Reflective conversation; evaluation questionnaire; individual self-assessment	Youthpass reflection; final self-evaluation; evaluation questionnaire

SPECIFIC FEATURES OF THE EDUCATIONAL PROGRAMME

Mentors from partner organisations are involved in the non-formal educational programme, specifically two from Slovenia and two from Croatia. Mentors from Slovenia contribute knowledge in the areas of digital communication, media literacy and online content development, while mentors from Croatia contribute experience in youth work, non-formal education and the development of civic competences.

Two guest lecturers, influencers who manage public social media pages with a significant number of followers, where they create counter-narratives, engage in satirical social commentary and address socially relevant topics, are also involved in the implementation of the boot camp. They provide participants with practical insights into activist digital communication, audience development, authentic public expression and the use of social media to promote socially important topics.

A distinctive feature of the programme is the combination of an intensive four-day boot camp and long-term six-month mentoring. The boot camp provides participants with basic knowledge and initial practical skills, while mentoring enables in-depth work, continuity, additional support and the actual production of digital content. In this way, the programme does not remain only at the level of education, but guides participants towards independent action.

During mentoring, the online communication platform Discord is used for regular communication, knowledge exchange, posting draft content, peer-to-peer comments and community building. Participants share their videos and other content on the platform, receive feedback from mentors and other participants, and improve the content before publishing it on social media.

The programme encourages experimentation with different digital formats, including vlogs, podcast formats, explainers, live streams, political satire, vox populi and other forms of socially critical digital expression. Content is developed through a low-budget DIY approach, showing young people that socially relevant communication does not require expensive production conditions, but rather a clear message, creativity, authenticity and responsibility.

Special emphasis is placed on inclusion and diversity. During participant selection, attention is paid to including young people from different social groups and backgrounds, while during the programme participants are encouraged to use inclusive language, subtitles, accessible formats and responsible representation of different social groups.

The programme ends with reflection on learning and the issuing of Youthpass certificates, enabling participants to recognise and articulate the competences they have acquired.

DURATION OF THE EDUCATIONAL PROGRAMME

Activities	**Duration**
Promotion, applications and inclusive selection of participants	Before the implementation of the boot camp
Videoactivism Academy Boot Camp	4 days
Online mentoring meetings	Approximately once a month
Work on digital content between mentoring meetings	Continuously over 6 months
Guest lectures and exchange of good practices	During the boot camp and mentoring
Publishing content and collecting feedback	During mentoring
Final reflection and Youthpass process	At the end of mentoring

TEACHING MATERIALS

Name of material	**Format**
Boot camp and mentoring curriculum	Document
Workshop plans for thematic modules	Lesson plans

Presentations for thematic modules	Presentations
Worksheet for analysing digital narratives, message design and digital counter-narrative	Worksheet
Examples of good practices in digital activism	Video materials / case studies
Instructions for basic vertical video and sound editing	Short guide / video instructions
Online platform for mentoring work	Discord or similar tool
Evaluation questionnaires	Online forms
Forms for self-reflection and the Youthpass process	Forms

EVALUATION OF THE EDUCATIONAL PROGRAMME

After each phase of programme implementation, an evaluation process is carried out.

During the boot camp, after individual modules, facilitators conduct a short oral reflection and evaluation of activities with participants. Participants have the opportunity to reflect on the module content, working methods, their own understanding of the topic, group work and the usefulness of what they have learned for their own digital engagement. In addition to oral reflections, short evaluation questionnaires or digital tools for quick feedback may be used.

At the end of the four-day boot camp, all participants complete an evaluation questionnaire examining their satisfaction with organisational and logistical aspects, the work of mentors, group dynamics, working methods and programme content. Part of the questionnaire is dedicated to self-assessment of the development of knowledge and skills, especially in the areas of active citizenship, European values, message crafting, and video and sound production.

During the six-month mentoring period, evaluation is carried out continuously through self-reflection, mentor feedback and peer-to-peer comments. Participants share their ideas, drafts and completed content via the online platform, where they receive feedback from mentors and other participants. Based on this feedback, they improve their content and develop their own approach to digital civic activism.

Mentors monitor participants' progress throughout the entire process, including their level of involvement, the quality of produced content, the development of independence and readiness for further civic engagement. When necessary, mentoring is adapted to participants' interests, needs and challenges.

At the end of the mentoring period, a final evaluation is conducted, including self-assessment of acquired competences, reflection on produced digital content, assessment of readiness for further activation and reflection on personal learning. The final evaluation also includes the Youthpass process, through which participants recognise, name and document the competences acquired during the programme. The evaluation of programme quality is based on multiple forms of feedback from participants, mentors, trainers and guest lecturers. The collected feedback is used as a basis for revising the curriculum, improving lesson plans, adapting materials and preparing future editions of the Academy.